X/Twitter AI System — Install Guide

Go from zero to generating viral X/Twitter posts in 15 minutes

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This guide walks you through installing and running the X/Twitter AI system I built with Claude Code. It tracks your competitors' top-performing tweets, analyzes what's working with deep AI analysis, and generates ready-to-publish posts with branded infographic images — all in your voice.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

A laptop. A Claude Pro or Max subscription ($20–100/month). API keys for Apify, Gemini, Anthropic, and Kie AI (Apify and Gemini have free tiers). That's it.

HOW IT WORKS

1. **Scrape**
   Apify pulls your competitors' recent tweets — sorted by engagement, top performers only
2. **Analyze**
   Gemini 2.5 Flash does deep multimodal analysis — text, images, hooks, structure, why it worked
3. **Generate**
   Claude generates posts in your voice — 60% with branded infographics (Kie AI), 30% with personal photos, 10% text-only
4. **Persist**
   Everything saved locally — posts to CSV, images downloaded to your machine

Part 1 — Install the Tools (5 min)

1. Install VS Code

- Go to code.visualstudio.com and click Download
- Open the installer, follow the prompts
- Launch it once so it's ready

2. Install Claude Code

- Go to claude.com/claude-code and follow the install instructions for your OS
- You need a Claude Pro ($20/mo) or Max ($100/mo) subscription
- Inside VS Code, open the terminal (`View → Terminal` or `Ctrl+``)
- Type `claude` and hit enter — sign in when prompted

3. Install Node.js

- Go to nodejs.org, download the LTS version, run the installer
- This lets the web app run on your machine

Part 2 — Get the Project (3 min)

4. Clone the repository

- Open the repo: github.com/melnikoff-oleg/x-ai
- Click the green `Code` button → `Download ZIP`
- Unzip it somewhere on your desktop
- In VS Code: `File → Open Folder` → pick the unzipped folder

5. Install dependencies

- Open the terminal in VS Code
- Navigate into the app folder: `cd app`
- Type `npm install` and wait (1–2 min)

Part 3 — Connect Your API Keys (5 min)

6. Get your API keys

- **Apify** — sign up at apify.com → Settings → API → copy your token (free tier: $5/month in credits)
- **Gemini** — go to aistudio.google.com/apikey → Create API key (free tier available)
- **Anthropic** — go to console.anthropic.com → API Keys → Create key (pay-as-you-go, ~$3/1M tokens)

- **Kie AI** — sign up at kie.ai → Dashboard → API Key (generates the branded infographic images)

7. Add keys to the project

- In the project root folder (not inside `app/`), copy the example file: `cp .env.example .env`
- Open the `.env` file and add your keys:

```
APIFY_API_TOKEN=your_apify_token
GEMINI_API_KEY=your_gemini_key
ANTHROPIC_API_KEY=your_anthropic_key
KIE_AI_API_KEY=your_kie_ai_key
```

Part 4 — Configure Your Niche (2 min)

8. Add your competitors

- Run the app: `npm run dev` (from inside the `app/` folder)
- Open `http://localhost:3000` in your browser
- Go to the **Creators** page
- Add X/Twitter accounts you want to track — paste their handles (e.g., CarlWeische, thejustinwelsh)
- The system comes pre-loaded with 8 marketing/CRO creators to get you started

9. Set up your config

- Go to the **Configs** page
- Edit the "Growth Marketing" config or create your own
- Set the analysis prompt (what to look for in competitor posts) and generation prompt (your tone of voice, niche, audience)

Part 5 — Run the Pipeline (5 min)

10. Generate your content

- Go to the **Run** page
- Select your config, set how many posts to analyze (default: 10)

- Click **Run Pipeline**
- Watch the 4 phases execute with a live progress bar:
- Phase 1: Scraping tweets (~5 seconds per creator)
- Phase 2: Deep AI analysis (Gemini analyzes each post)
- Phase 3: Content generation (Claude writes posts + Kie AI creates infographics)
- Phase 4: Saving results

11. Review your generated posts

- Go to the **Posts** page
- You'll see side-by-side cards: original tweet on the left, your AI-generated version on the right
- Click any card to see the full analysis, original content, and generated draft
- Generated infographic images are saved in `data/generated-images/`
- Download, edit, or post directly to X

THAT'S IT

The system runs locally on your machine. Every time you want fresh content, just open the app and run the pipeline again. Your competitors do the testing — you get the results. Three types of posts keep your feed diverse: branded infographics, personal posts with your photos, and text-only hot takes.

Customizing Your Brand Style

Making it yours

- The infographic style is defined in `app/src/lib/brand-style.ts`
- Add your own reference infographics to the `references/` folder
- Add personal photos as `references/personal 1.jpg`, `personal 2.jpg`, etc. — these get paired with personal-category posts
- Edit the generation prompts on the Configs page to match your voice and niche
- 5 infographic styles rotate automatically: bar charts, proportional blocks, ranked lists, timelines, and pyramid/funnels

All the links in one place

GitHub repo — github.com/melnikoff-oleg/x-ai

VS Code — code.visualstudio.com

Claude Code — claude.com/claude-code

Node.js — nodejs.org

Apify — apify.com

Gemini API — aistudio.google.com/apikey

Anthropic API — console.anthropic.com

Kie AI — kie.ai

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Stuck? Drop a comment in the Skool post — I'll help you get it running.